

dpnranker.com - Technical Reference Manual

1. Document Information

Property	Details
Product Name	dpnranker.com (Dentsu Podcast Network Ranker)
Version	2.0
Document Date	July 21, 2026
Owner	Dentsu Podcast Network
Purpose	Official technical reference, architectural baseline, and security implementation guide.
Intended Audience	AI & InfoSec, Compliance, and Audit Stakeholders

Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Description
1.0	2026-06-25	Dentsu Podcast Network	Initial baseline version representing the production deployment architecture.
2.0	2026-07-21	Dentsu Podcast Network	Security improvements including rate limiting, strict HTTP headers, and IDOR prevention details.

2. Executive Summary

dpnranker.com is a proprietary web application developed for the Dentsu Podcast Network. It serves as a centralized creator marketplace and algorithmic podcast ranking index.

Business Purpose

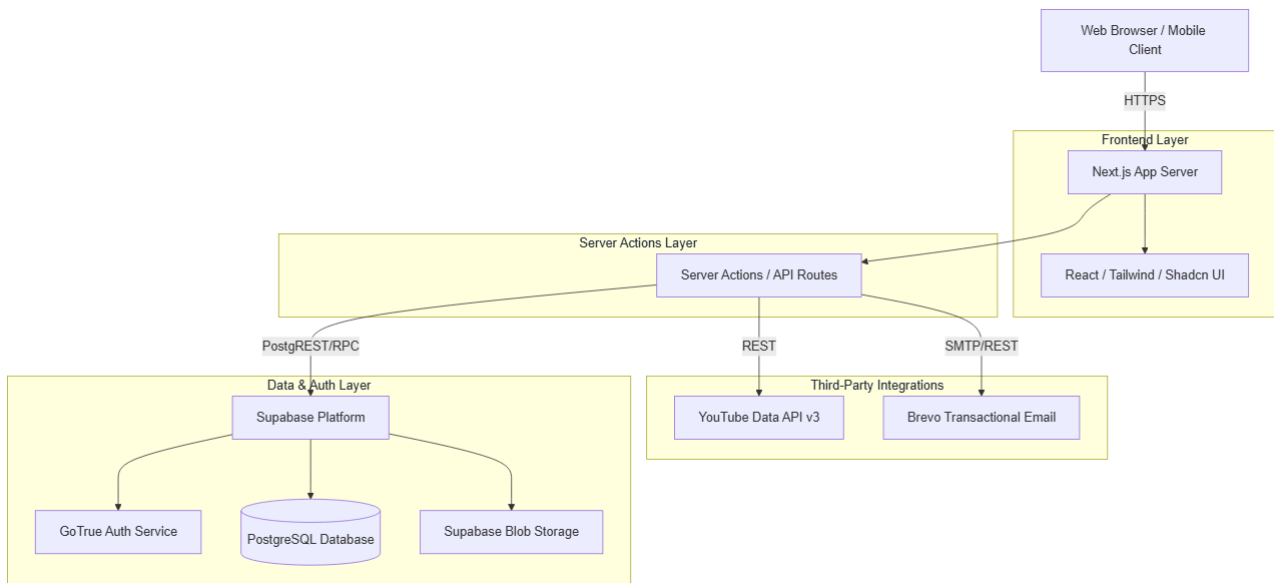
The platform connects brands, agencies, and podcast creators by aggregating real-time analytics. It replaces fragmented data collection with a unified, transparent, and algorithmic "DPN Score" that normalizes audience penetration against engagement vectors. This empowers advertisers to make data-driven media investments while giving creators a platform to showcase their verified analytics.

Core Capabilities

- **Algorithmic Ranking Engine:** Synthesizes logarithmic scaling of 7-day cumulative YouTube audience penetration with relative engagement density vectors.
- **Creator Management:** Automated onboarding workflows allowing creators to securely claim their indexed podcasts via Magic Link verification.
- **Agency Portal:** Dedicated interfaces for media buyers and agency representatives to explore verified podcast inventory.
- **Admin Orchestration:** Centralized Super Admin controls to seed new podcasts, manage rankings, enforce data integrity, and dictate feature flags.

3. System Architecture

The application employs a decoupled, serverless-oriented architecture leveraging Next.js (App Router) backed by Supabase (PostgreSQL + Auth).



Deployment Architecture

The application is currently containerized and deployed via PM2 on a managed Ubuntu VPS (Hostinger), utilizing Nginx as a reverse proxy with SSL termination.

4. Technology Stack

Technology	Category	Purpose	Integration Profile
Next.js (v14+)	Framework	Full-stack React framework utilizing App Router.	Handles all routing, SSR/SSG rendering, and Server Actions for secure backend execution.
React	UI Library	Component-based UI rendering.	Powers the client-side interactivity and state management.
Tailwind CSS	Styling	Utility-first CSS framework.	Enables rapid, consistent, and responsive styling across the platform.
Shadcn UI	UI Components	Accessible, customizable component primitives.	Provides the baseline design system (buttons, modals, tooltips) ensuring UI consistency.
Supabase	Backend-as-a-Service	Database, Auth, and Storage.	Core data layer; utilizes PostgreSQL with Row Level Security (RLS) to enforce data boundaries.
YouTube API v3	External API	Data ingestion and analytics tracking.	Fetches live subscriber counts, views, latest video URLs, and topic categories for algorithmic scoring.
Brevo	Email Service	Transactional email orchestration.	Delivers secure Magic Links and administrative invites.

Technology	Category	Purpose	Integration Profile
PM2	Process Manager	Production process orchestration.	Ensures the Next.js Node process runs continuously on the Hostinger VPS with automatic restarts.

NOTE:

Supabase is utilized as a hosted PaaS, offloading database maintenance, real-time socket management, and authentication infrastructure to a specialized provider.

5. Functional Modules

5.1. The Ranker Engine

- **Purpose:** Calculates and displays the proprietary DPN Score.
- **Inputs:** YouTube Subscriber Count, Total Views, Total Videos, Views (Last 7 Days).
- **Business Logic:** Applies a proprietary, non-linear algorithmic matrix to generate a normalized index.
- **Dependencies:** YouTube API, Postgres `podcasts` table, Postgres `channel_stats_history` table.

5.2. Identity & Access Management (IAM)

- **Purpose:** Manages user registration, role assignment, and access controls.
- **Inputs:** OAuth tokens, Email/Password, Magic Link tokens.
- **Business Logic:** Maps authenticated sessions to `profiles.role` (e.g., `creator`, `agency_user`, `super_admin`). Restricts UI elements and server actions based on these roles.
- **Dependencies:** Supabase GoTrue.

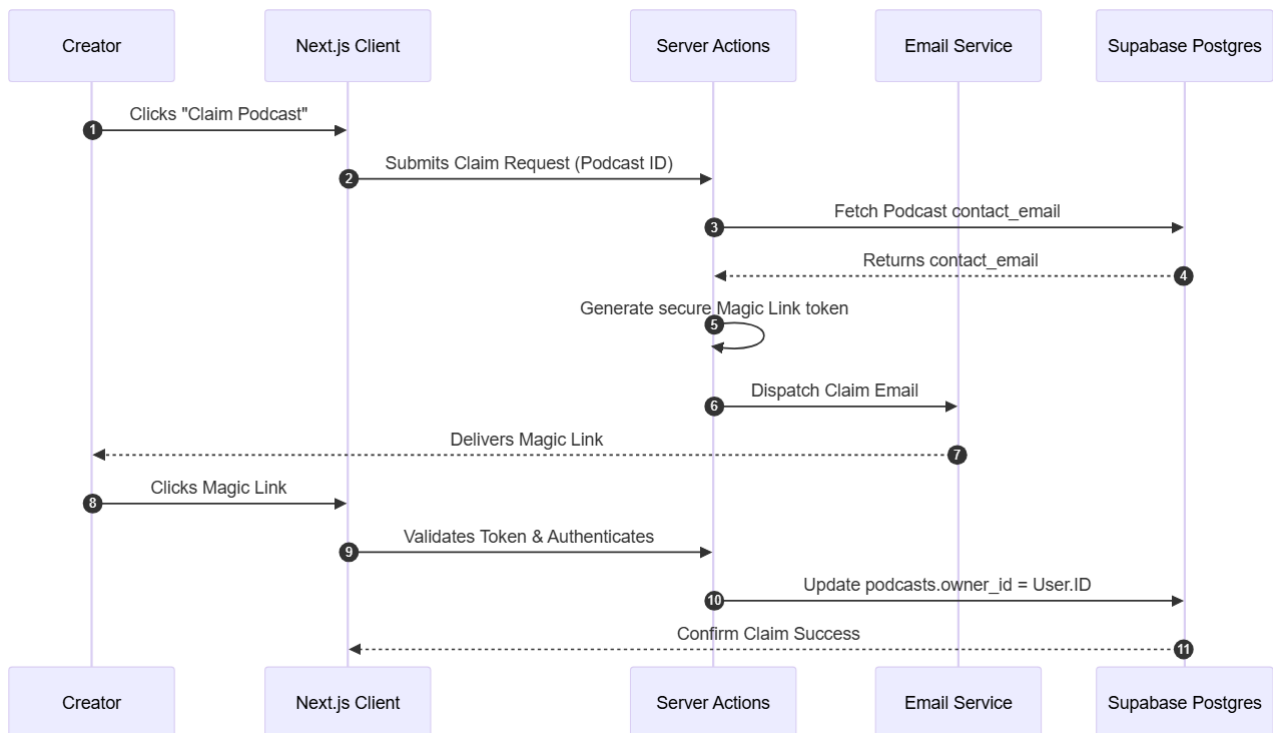
5.3. Admin Orchestration Console

- **Purpose:** Empowers administrators to manage the platform without direct database access.
- **Business Logic:** Allows admins to seed podcasts via YouTube URLs, manually override genres, revoke unauthorized claims, and manually trigger 7-day stat recalculations.
- **Security:** Protected by strict `getAdminUser()` server-side validations utilizing the `SERVICE_ROLE_KEY` to bypass standard RLS when performing global administrative tasks.

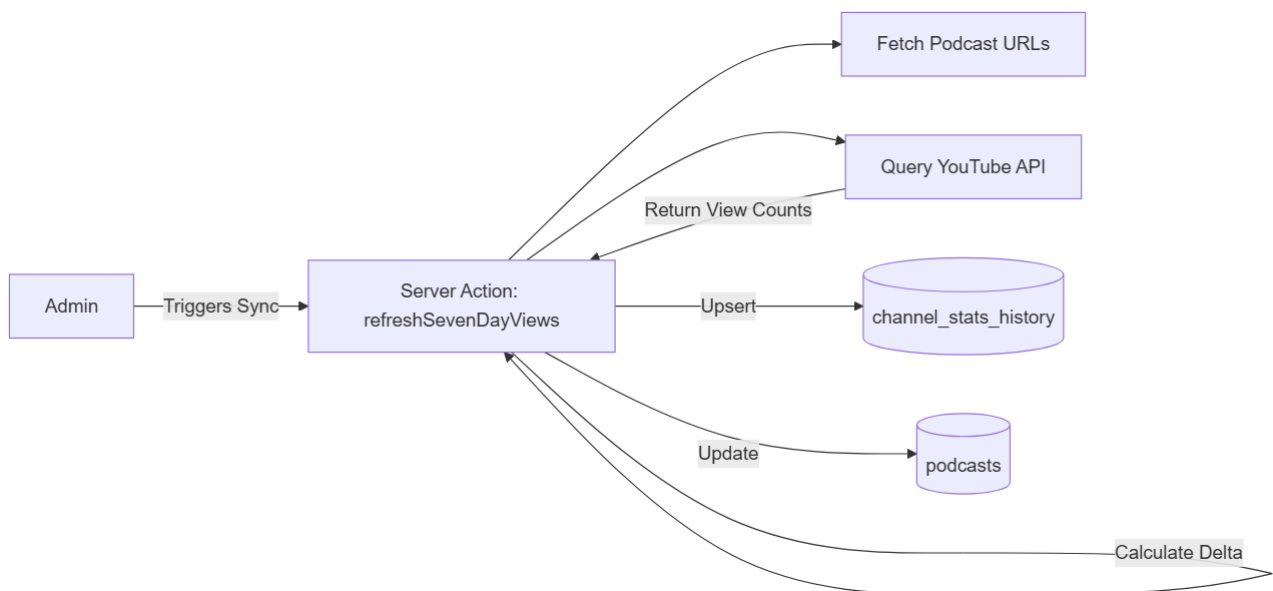
6. Process Flows

Creator Claim Workflow

This is a critical security workflow designed to prevent Insecure Direct Object Reference (IDOR) takeovers of podcast profiles.



YouTube Data Synchronization



7. API Documentation

Internal Server Actions (Next.js)

The application relies heavily on Next.js Server Actions rather than traditional REST endpoints.

- `adminSeedPodcast(youtubeUrl)`: Fetches YouTube channel statistics and inserts a new seeded record.
- `refreshSevenDayViews()`: Iterates over all approved podcasts to fetch current metrics and calculate the 7-day delta.
- `updatePodcastGenre(id, newGenre)`: Updates the canonical genre using standardized dropdown values.

External API Usage: YouTube Data API v3

- **Endpoints Used:** `/channels`, `/playlistItems`, `/videos`
- **Rate Limits:** Bounded by Google Cloud Quotas (default 10,000 units/day).
- **Error Handling:** Graceful fallbacks implemented. If the API fails or rate limits are hit, the application retains the most recent valid snapshot.

8. Database Design

The database is built on **PostgreSQL**, hosted via Supabase.

Core Entity-Relationship Model

- **profiles**: Extends the `auth.users` table. Contains `role`, `full_name`, and `company`.
- **podcasts**: The primary entity. Contains statistics, URLs, metadata, and algorithmic inputs. Linked to `profiles.id` via `owner_id`.
- **channel_stats_history**: Time-series table logging daily snapshots of `total_views` and `subscriber_count` for trend analysis.
- **agencies**: Stores agency profiles and verification status.

[!TIP]

The `channel_stats_history` table utilizes a unique constraint on `(podcast_id, recorded_date)` to facilitate idempotency via `upsert` operations.

9. Security Architecture

The platform was engineered with a security-first posture, anticipating modern threat vectors.

9.1. Access Control & IAM

- **Authentication:** Managed entirely by Supabase Auth (GoTrue), ensuring industry-standard hashing, session management, and JWT signing.
- **Row Level Security (RLS):** Enabled on all Postgres tables. Database policies explicitly define read/write permissions based on `auth.uid()`.
- **Server-Side Authorization:** Next.js Server Actions re-verify permissions utilizing a rigorous `getAdminUser()` utility before processing administrative state mutations.

9.2. Protection Against Common Threats

Threat Vector	Mitigation Strategy
SQL Injection	Nullified via Supabase ORM/PostgREST which natively parameterizes all database queries.
XSS (Cross-Site Scripting)	React inherently escapes dynamic content rendering. Unsafe raw HTML injection (<code>dangerouslySetInnerHTML</code>) is strictly prohibited.
CSRF (Cross-Site Request Forgery)	Next.js Server Actions implement native Origin validation and anti-CSRF tokens.
IDOR / Privilege Escalation	Ownership mutations (e.g., claiming a podcast) require out-of-band verification (Magic Link sent to the canonical channel email). Server actions explicitly validate the requesting user's <code>owner_id</code> .
Secrets Leakage	Critical tokens (<code>SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY</code> , <code>YOUTUBE_API_KEY</code>) are isolated to server-side environments and never exposed to the client bundle (<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_</code> prefix is strictly avoided for sensitive keys).
DDoS & Spam (Feature Abuse)	In-memory IP-based rate limiting is enforced on sensitive forms (e.g., <code>switchUserCategory</code> for creator applications) to prevent automated spam and exhaustion.
Clickjacking & MIME-Sniffing	<code>next.config.ts</code> enforces <code>X-Frame-Options: DENY</code> , <code>X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff</code> , and <code>Strict-Transport-Security</code> headers on all responses.

[!CAUTION]

RLS Bypass Note: Administrative functions purposefully utilize the Supabase `SERVICE_ROLE_KEY` to bypass Row Level Security. This is a design requirement for global admin actions. The security of this bypass relies entirely on the integrity of the `getAdminUser()` check at the entry point of the server action.

10. Privacy & Compliance

DPDP Act (2023) Considerations

The platform adheres to the principles of India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act (2023):

- **Data Minimization:** We collect only essential personal data explicitly required to facilitate B2B portal functionality.

- **Consent Management:** Through our Creator and Agency signup forms, users are presented with clear opt-in requirements. Users provide express consent prior to sharing any personal or corporate information onto the platform.
- **Purpose Limitation:** Information collected through verified opt-ins is used strictly for platform services (such as matchmaking creators with agencies) and is not repurposed or sold to non-participating third parties.

11. Reliability & Operations

- **Hosting Environment:** Ubuntu VPS via Hostinger.
- **Process Management:** pm2 ensures process persistence and automatic restarts on crash.
- **Data Backups:** Handled natively by the Supabase platform (Point-in-Time Recovery enabled based on project tier).
- **Graceful Degradation:** If the YouTube API experiences an outage, the platform gracefully degrades by displaying the last known cached metrics rather than returning 500 errors to the client.

12. Deployment

Current Deployment Pipeline (Manual/Scripted):

1. Code is versioned in GitHub.
2. Administrator SSH access into the Hostinger VPS.
3. Execution of the deployment script: `cd /root/dpn-ranker git pull npm run build pm2 restart dpnranker`

13. Risks & Assumptions

Technical Assumptions

- **YouTube API Stability:** The algorithmic engine assumes the YouTube API schema and quota availability will remain consistent.
- **Single Node Deployment:** The Next.js application runs on a single VPS. It assumes traffic patterns will remain within the vertical scaling limits of the instance.

Potential Risks

- **Admin Gateway Exposure:** While server actions are heavily gated behind `getAdminUser()` checks, any compromise of the `studio@ideabrews.com` credentials could lead to broad system access.

14. Feature Update Log

Version: 2.0

Release Date: July 21, 2026

Summary: Security Hardening and Top Gainers Logic

New Features

- Introduced "Top Gainers" and "Losers" filters on the main Labs Rankings, correctly isolating changes strictly within the Top 100.
- Implemented "NEW" badge logic to clearly distinguish brand-new entries breaking into the Top 100 without prior historical data.

Security Improvements

- Implemented strict HTTP Security Headers (X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options, Strict-Transport-Security) via `next.config.ts`.
- Introduced custom LRU in-memory IP-based rate limiting to protect public forms (e.g., Creator/Agency applications).
- Addressed potential rendering bugs where UI layers incorrectly bypassed `calculateHistoricalMetrics` evaluations.

Version: 1.0

Release Date: June 25, 2026

Summary: Baseline Production Release

New Features

- Initial deployment of algorithmic Ranker Engine.
- Secure Creator Claim workflow via Magic Link.
- Super Admin orchestration dashboard.

Enhancements

- Standardized canonical genre dropdowns across all creator, agency, and admin portals.

Security Improvements

- Implementation of out-of-band email verification to prevent IDOR attacks during podcast claiming.
- Strict Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) enforced on all server actions.

Infrastructure Changes

- PM2 production deployment on Hostinger VPS.
- Supabase integration configured for Auth and Database persistence.